

DALE COLLEGE

DIGITAL WEBSITE EXPERIENCE

A modern digital identity built around heritage, culture, sport and the future.

PER ARDUA AD ASTRA

Website Concept & Development Blueprint

Prepared for development in Visual Studio Code

September 2026

1. Executive Vision

The proposed Dale College website should not feel like a conventional school website. It should feel like a digital representation of the College itself: historic, prestigious, competitive, energetic, disciplined and forward-looking.

The central concept is: “Dale, Reimagined.” The website will combine the College’s heritage with premium modern web design, cinematic imagery, interactive storytelling, sophisticated animation and a strong mobile experience.

The website should make prospective learners and parents immediately understand what Dale stands for while also giving current learners, staff and Old Dalians a reason to return.

2. Core Website Goals

- Create a memorable first impression that feels significantly different from a generic school website.
- Showcase Dale College’s history, traditions and identity in a modern digital format.
- Attract prospective learners and parents through an emotional and visual experience.
- Present academics, sport, culture, boarding and school life clearly without overwhelming visitors.
- Create a strong platform for news, events, achievements and social-media content.
- Strengthen the connection between current Dalians and the Old Dalian community.
- Make admissions and enquiries simple and highly visible.
- Build the website using maintainable technologies that can be developed and managed in Visual Studio Code.

3. Design Direction

The visual direction should combine four characteristics:

Characteristic	How it appears
Heritage	Historical photography, archival storytelling, traditional typography accents and references to Dale’s legacy.
Premium	Strong whitespace, restrained colour use, large typography, cinematic imagery and polished transitions.
Energy	Sport photography, dynamic scrolling, interactive cards, match-centre concepts and movement.
Future	Modern UI, smooth animation, responsive layouts, interactive maps/timelines and selected experimental effects.

4. Colour & Visual System

Recommended visual palette:

- Near-black / charcoal: primary background and premium sections.
- Deep Dale red: brand accents, buttons, active states and important highlights.
- Off-white: primary text and light content sections.
- Muted grey: supporting text and secondary information.
- Subtle heritage gold: optional accent used sparingly for prestige and historical details.

The website should avoid using red everywhere. Red should act as a deliberate accent against a dark, premium visual foundation.

5. Typography

- Display font: a bold condensed or editorial typeface for large headlines and section titles.
- Body font: a clean modern sans-serif such as Inter or Manrope for readability.
- Use oversized typography as a visual element, not simply as text.
- Use short statements and strong phrases to create rhythm throughout the site.

Example visual language:

FORGED BY TRADITION.

BUILT FOR THE FUTURE.

6. Homepage Experience

The homepage should be the strongest part of the website. It should guide visitors through Dale’s identity rather than simply listing information.

Section	Concept
01 — Cinematic Hero	Full-screen imagery or video, large DALE typography, PER ARDUA AD ASTRA, EST. 1861 and a subtle scroll prompt.
02 — Legacy Introduction	A transition from historical Dale imagery to present-day imagery with the message: 1861 → 2026.
03 — Interactive History	A scroll-driven timeline showing key moments in the College’s development.
04 — Life at Dale	Large visual cards for Academics, Sport, Culture, Service and Boarding.
05 — Explore the Campus	Interactive campus imagery with clickable locations and facility information.
06 — Sport / Match Centre	Fixtures, results, teams, sporting highlights and visual sports content.
07 — Dalian Stories	Stories featuring learners, staff, achievements and Old Dalians.
08 — News & Events	A modern, easily scannable stream of current College information.
09 — Social Feed	A visual social-media section connected to the College’s Instagram/Facebook presence.
10 — Admissions CTA	A strong closing section encouraging visitors to enquire, visit or apply.

7. Navigation Concept

Instead of a traditional school-style navigation bar, the site should use a minimalist floating navigation with a full-screen menu.

- DALE logo / wordmark on the left.
- Small section indicators or navigation links on desktop.

- Circular menu button for the full navigation.
- Full-screen animated menu with large typography.
- Persistent high-priority action such as Admissions or Enquire.

Suggested main sections:

- The College
- Academics
- Sport
- Culture
- Boarding
- Old Dalians
- News & Events
- Admissions
- Contact

8. Interactive Heritage & History

Dale's history should become an interactive experience rather than a static block of text.

1. Introduce the school's origin and heritage with archival imagery.
2. Create a horizontal or vertical timeline.
3. Animate historical photographs into view as the visitor scrolls.
4. Use dates as large visual anchors.
5. Connect historical milestones to the modern College.
6. End the sequence with the present day and a forward-looking message.

9. The Heron as a Digital Motif

The heron can become a recurring visual motif rather than simply appearing inside the logo.

- Use a subtle heron silhouette during the loading sequence.
- Use the heron as a transition or section marker.
- Consider a subtle particle or line-art interpretation for selected interactive sections.
- Keep the treatment sophisticated and restrained so it remains appropriate for a historic school.

10. Sport & Competition

Sport should be presented as a major part of the Dale experience, with a visual language closer to a professional sports platform than a traditional school page.

- Next Fixture card.
- Results and fixtures.
- Sport-specific pages.
- Team and squad sections where appropriate.
- Match photography and galleries.
- Sporting achievements and records.
- Optional live/update functionality in a later phase.

11. “A Day at Dale” Interactive Experience

Create a timeline that shows what a typical day can feel like at Dale. This gives prospective families an emotional understanding of the student experience.

- Morning / arrival
- Assembly
- Academic classes
- Break and social life
- Lunch
- Sport and activities
- Study / boarding
- Evening routine

12. Interactive Campus

Create an “Explore Dale” section using a strong campus photograph, aerial view or future custom illustration. Visitors can select locations to learn more.

- Main school buildings
- Assembly / heritage spaces
- Classrooms and academic facilities
- Sports facilities
- Boarding facilities
- Important landmarks and gathering spaces

13. Old Dalian Experience

The Old Dalian section should feel like an archive and community rather than a simple directory.

- Old Dalian stories
- Notable Dalians
- Achievements and career stories
- Alumni news
- Historical photographs
- Potential future searchable archive

14. News, Events & Social Media

- Modern news cards with categories and dates.
- Upcoming events section.
- Visual Instagram-style gallery.
- Links to official social channels.
- Potential future integration with a content management system.

Official social channels supplied for the project: Facebook — facebook.com/DaleCollege; Instagram — instagram.com/dalecollegeza/

15. Admissions & Conversion

The website should ultimately convert interest into action. Admissions should therefore be visible throughout the experience rather than hidden on a single page.

- Enquire
- Admissions information
- Book / request a visit
- Application information
- Contact the College
- Clear contact details on mobile

16. Animation & Interaction Strategy

Animation should make the site feel premium and immersive while remaining fast and usable.

- GSAP for controlled, high-quality animation.
- GSAP ScrollTrigger for scroll-based reveals and timelines.
- Lenis for smooth scrolling where appropriate.
- Parallax image movement.
- Text reveal animations.
- Magnetic or responsive buttons.
- Image hover interactions.
- Smooth page/section transitions.
- Micro-interactions for menus, cards and navigation.
- Reduced-motion support for accessibility.

Three.js/WebGL should only be introduced where it adds genuine value. It should not be used simply because it is technically impressive.

17. Recommended Development Stack

Technology	Purpose
HTML5	Semantic website structure
CSS3	Responsive design, layout and visual system
JavaScript	Interactions and application logic
GSAP	Premium animations
GSAP ScrollTrigger	Scroll-driven animation
Lenis	Smooth scrolling
Swiper.js	Galleries, sliders and carousels
Lucide Icons	Clean interface icons
VS Code	Primary development environment

18. Proposed VS Code Project Structure

```
dale-college/
├── index.html
├── pages/
│   ├── about.html
│   ├── academics.html
│   └── sport.html
```

```
| culture.html
| boarding.html
| old-dalians.html
| admissions.html
| contact.html
|
|— css/
|   | main.css
|   | components.css
|   | animations.css
|   | responsive.css
|   |
|— js/
|   | main.js
|   | animations.js
|   | navigation.js
|   | history.js
|   | sport.js
|   |
|— assets/
|   | images/
|   | videos/
|   | icons/
|   | logo/
```

19. Mobile-First & Responsive Requirements

- Design for mobile, tablet and desktop from the beginning.
- Touch-friendly navigation and controls.
- Optimised image sizes and modern image formats.
- Avoid animations that reduce usability on mobile.
- Provide a reduced-motion option for accessibility.
- Maintain fast load times even with large photography and video.

20. Performance & Accessibility

- Compress and appropriately size all images.
- Lazy-load below-the-fold media.
- Use semantic HTML.
- Maintain strong colour contrast.
- Provide alt text for meaningful imagery.
- Ensure keyboard navigation works.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion.
- Avoid unnecessary third-party libraries.

21. Content & Assets Required

- Official Dale College logo / crest in high resolution.
- Current school photography.
- Historical photographs and archival material.
- Campus photographs / aerial photography.
- Sports photography and team images.

- School colours and any existing brand guidelines.
- Admissions information.
- Academic information.
- Sporting information and fixtures where available.
- Boarding information.
- News and event content.
- Official social-media links.
- Contact information.

22. Development Roadmap

Stage	Deliverable
Stage 1 — Foundation	Set up project structure, typography, colour system, navigation and responsive framework.
Stage 2 — Homepage	Build the cinematic hero, homepage sections, animation system and responsive behaviour.
Stage 3 — Content Pages	Build About, Academics, Sport, Culture, Boarding, Old Dalians, Admissions and Contact.
Stage 4 — Interactive Features	Implement history timeline, campus exploration, sport match centre and enhanced interactions.
Stage 5 — Content & Optimisation	Add real content, imagery, metadata, accessibility improvements and performance optimisation.
Stage 6 — Testing & Deployment	Cross-browser testing, mobile testing, SEO checks, final polish and deployment.

23. Definition of Success

The finished website should achieve the following:

- A visitor immediately recognises Dale’s identity.
- The site feels premium and modern without losing its heritage.
- Prospective families can understand the Dale experience within minutes.
- Sport and student life feel energetic and authentic.
- History feels immersive rather than static.
- Admissions and contact actions are easy to find.
- The website works exceptionally well on mobile.
- Animations feel intentional and polished.
- The site loads quickly and remains accessible.
- The design is distinctive enough that it does not look like a standard school template.

24. Creative North Star

“1861 → THE NEXT CHAPTER”

The website should communicate one central idea: Dale’s history is not something sitting in the past. It is the foundation for the next generation.

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